big cat'.

As Superintendent K. R. Kishore explained: 'This [outing] had a salutary effect on the mothers, who started accepting their children and caring for them. Tension had certainly come down.'

The jail superintendent further focused on this aspect: 'The majority of the Indian women prisoners were very poor and so special attention had been given to this aspect. A number of voluntary organizations were contacted and these prisoners got job works. As a result about 40 women prisoners even opened bank accounts for themselves. Every week a bank official came and explained to them the interest they earned as well as the current status of their accounts. This was done so that our credibility was maintained with them, lest suspicion brew that their money was being misused'.

'I need teachers, I need preachers, I need books, I need jobs …', appealed Kiran Bedi to the community. The response was overwhelming. Tihar HQ was flooded with proposals, projects and applications from volunteers – individuals and groups alike.

The Indira Gandhi National Open University (IGNOU) announced the establishment of a regular study centre in Tihar for providing higher education to inmates and staff. IGNOU even agreed to modify its norms and consented to conduct the examinations in the jail premises itself. It offered to provide education, study material and audiovisual aids free of cost to prisoners as also help set up an educational video library, again free of cost.

Postgraduate and graduate courses were offered along with programmes and diplomas in management, computers, rural development, nutrition and health care as also creative writing. Twenty-five people, including staff and prisoners, undertook these courses.

Jail 4, which housed the juvenile wards, was adopted by the Bharat Vikas Parishad. This body funded the sports activities of the jail, and a number of interbarracks and interjail tournaments were organized. All the advantages and benefits that accrued from a healthy sports atmosphere soon became evident. It was with a view to encouraging sports and games that the juvenile wards were named after the famous cricketers Sachin Tendulkar and Vinod Kambli, as the 'Sachin' and 'Kambli' wards.

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An ingenious scheme, devised by certain inmates, to 'beat the system', was exposed. The details are, indeed, worth narrating. In June 1993 three doctors were discovered to be involved in certain irregularities and they were immediately transferred. The *modus operandi* was soon discovered. Undertrials who were to appear in court (on police requests for them to be taken into their custody for uncovering evidence in their cases) would, on payment to certain doctors, be provided medical certificates to avoid such custody. The police were allowed by law a period of 15 days from arrest for keeping a suspect in custody. This period was thus made to comfortably lapse.

This tie-up with the doctors even permitted a number of prisoners to continue perpetrating crimes even from within the jail. In April 1993, the police of the Bara Hindu Rao area in Delhi came upon a group of abductors who used to demand ransom money. This group was headed by Anil and Amit Tyagi, both of whom were lodged in Tihar Jail at that time.

A young student of the Maharashtra Polytechnic Institute had been abducted and his parents were asked to meet Amit Tyagi on the date he would be taken to AIIMS (All India Institute of Medical Sciences) on a 'referral' for a medical check-up by the Tihar doctor. It was, at that stage, discovered that this same Amit Tyagi had extorted Rs 180,000 in an earlier abduction case by virtue of the same 'referral' system.

This revelation effectively destroyed the doctor–prisoner nexus, which was the root cause of many